

CHAPTER 07

THE POPULATION OF PAKISTAN



POPULATION SIZE AND COMPOSITION

Pakistan's population is diverse and rapidly growing, with various ethnic groups such as Punjabis, Sindhis, Pashtuns, and Baloch, among others. The population is predominantly young, with a significant proportion under the age of 30. This demographic structure presents both challenges and opportunities for the nation's development. The study of the changing numbers of births and deaths in a society over a specified period of time is called demography. Pakistan is a densely populated country, with a density of 166 people per square kilometer. In Punjab 358, in Sindh 218, in KPK 238, in Balochistan 19, in the Capital City ISLAMABAD it 889 per square kilometer.

LITERACY AND NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT

The literacy rate in Pakistan reflects the percentage of people over the age of 15 who can read and write. Literacy is crucial for national development because an educated workforce is better equipped to participate in the economy and contribute to the country's growth. Literacy rate in Pakistan remain low due to low economic progress. High literacy rates are associated with improved productivity, innovation, and better quality of life.

EFFECT OF GROWTH AND MIGRATION ON COUNTRIES DEVELOPMENT

The growth and migration of the population can put pressure on the country's resources and infrastructure. Rapid urbanization can lead to overcrowding in cities, while migration affects the distribution and use of resources. To sustain development, it is necessary to manage these changes effectively by planning urban expansion, providing educational and job opportunities, and ensuring equitable resource distribution.

Pakistan is a densely populated country. Its total resources are not increasing in proportion with the rate of growth of population. The rate at which the population is increasing has caused a population explosion. It has resulted in the rise of unemployment, and a decrease in the facilities of sanitation, health and education. It is necessary to reduce the rate of population growth and to increase the national resources. The majority of the Pakistanis live in rural areas. As a result of fast increase in population and less chances of employment in the villages, people have started moving to the cities. In spite of employment, there are other attractions for people in cities, e.g., better opportunities of education and health, cultural activities and recreational facilities. Therefore, people's trend to migrate to cities from villages is increasing day by day

CAUSES OF POPULATION INCREASE

Population growth in Pakistan can be attributed to several factors including high birth rates, improvements in healthcare leading to lower mortality rates, and cultural norms favoring larger families. The government and non-governmental organizations are working to address these causes through family planning programs and by raising awareness about the benefits of smaller family sizes

- **Social factor:** Majority of the people believe that ALLAH is the sustainer and provider. Many people think that having a large family is a source of strength.
- **No to family planning:** People do not think and take interest in family planning.
- **Poverty:** Poverty is yet another reason. People think that they get rid of poverty by having a large family
- **Early marriages:** Early marriages also added to the growth of children.

- **Lack of education:** The low literacy rate also contributes to the higher population growth.
- **Desire:** The desire for a male results in producing more children

BALANCING POPULATION AND RESOURCES

Maintaining a balance between the growing population and the national resources requires strategic planning and policies. This includes investing in renewable energy, promoting sustainable agriculture, and ensuring that developments in infrastructure keep pace with population growth. Education and empowerment of women are also crucial, as they are directly related to family planning and health.

HEALTH AND EDUCATION CHALLENGES

A lot of work has to be done in the health sector, as at the time of independence only 2 were medical colleges were established which have now become 46 in numbers. We have a lack of government hospitals and health facilities. People have more health problems in villages than in cities. Our doctors do not want to work in villages. The villagers are, therefore, bound to go to the quacks for treatment. In cities, people are having difficulties in connection with treatment facilities because private doctors charge very high fees. Private hospitals and clinics also charge a lot of fees while the condition of government hospitals beyond description.

EFFECT OF GROWING POPULATION ON HEALTH

The government's efforts to promote primary education have failed and the literacy rate is still low. The standard of primary education is very low. The standard of education at all level is low. The reasons for that are low standard of academic programs, old methods of exams, lack of schools and teachers in rural areas etc. These trends are lowering our level of education day by day. The fast population growth rate is also hindering the elimination of illiteracy and nonstandard education.

EFFECTS ON HEALTH AND EDUCATION

A growing population strains health and education systems. More people mean a greater need for hospitals, healthcare professionals, and educational institutions. Ensuring access to quality health care and education for all, particularly in rural areas, is vital. The government's role in allocating sufficient resources to these sectors is critical in managing the effects of a growing population.